Publications Office
of the European Union

Annual Management Report

A year in facts and figures

2024

Executive summary

Manuscript completed in April 2025

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Foreword

Interview with

Petr BLÍŽKOVSKÝ

Secretary-General of the European Committee of the Regions and Chair of the Management Committee



Question | *2024 was the fourth year of the European Committee of the Regions as the Chair of the Management Committee. How do you see the development of the Office since you took on the Chairmanship in 2021?*

Petr Blížkovský | The last years brought steady progress towards digital transformation, interoperability, an increasing focus on data and data visualisation as well as fostering interinstitutional synergies. Starting from the Office's core business, publishing EU law in all official languages to give it legal effect and make it accessible to all, the completion of the Official Journal act-by-act project changed the way in which we publish the *Official Journal of the European Union*, with major efficiency gains. This allowed the Office last year to publish seamlessly over 3 million pages in the Official Journal, an all-time record. The new eForms for public procurement facilitate interoperability and reuse of data. The Office's work on open data is critical to transparency, accountability and evidence-based decision-making across policy fields, empowering citizens in democratic processes and fostering novel business opportunities. Its efforts on standardisation of metadata and digital formats, the progress made in using artificial intelligence, and the shift from paper to digital need to be highlighted. The Office achieved all this in a difficult geopolitical context which put extra pressure on the publication of EU law and contributed to stepping up challenges for cybersecurity. The Office has firmly established itself as a centre of excellence for data, information and knowledge management, in addition to being an interinstitutional provider of publishing services, and this change was reflected in the formulation of the updated strategic objectives which the Management Committee approved and will support in the future.

Question | *In 2024, the Management Committee approved the new strategic objectives for the Office. They ensure continuity but allow the Office also to adapt to new challenges. How do they prepare the Office for the future?*

Petr Blížkovský | The Office must fulfil its legal mandate, to serve EU institutions as stakeholders and provide impactful services with European added value to end-users: EU and Member States' public administrations, citizens, businesses, NGOs and the public at large. At the same time, the Office must adapt to new challenges. The vision of the Publications Office is to be a reliable, practical, forward-looking centre of excellence in data, information and knowledge management for the EU institutions that, through the skills and expertise, services and advice it provides, helps them to make decisions based on reliable evidence and to present and publish policies, decisions and outcomes in a way that is understandable, findable, accessible, interoperable and reusable for all. As a reliable source of trustworthy, relevant, multilingual data, information and knowledge about the EU, the Office aims to help people to make informed decisions and make the most of all the opportunities the European Union has to offer. That is why the Office's existing thematic Strategic objectives, which remain relevant, have been complemented with three crosscutting horizontal Strategic objectives: client orientation, strategic outreach, and harnessing new technologies, in particular artificial intelligence (AI), in a trustworthy way to provide high-value data, information and knowledge services. To ensure effective implementation, the Office envisages leveraging a number of enablers: innovative solutions including AI; future-ready staff; and a set of practical toolkits.



Interview with

Hilde HARDEMAN

Director-General of the Publications Office of the European Union

Question | ***2024 was marked by an accelerated adoption of AI tools. How does AI shape our work, and how are we preparing for the future?***

Hilde Hardeman | To allow users and reusers to make the most of all services we deliver, and to allow us to deliver better services, a key strand that is guiding our work for the years to come is to harness new technologies, in particular artificial intelligence, in a trustworthy way. AI is transforming operations in the publication field, fostering the development of new services and altering both user expectations and the broader operational context. The Office seeks to make the most of this with initiatives such as SeTA@OP to assist in attributing metadata and the use of AI to map the EU *acquis*, facilitate access to public procurement notices or enhance search functions, always taking a human-in-the-loop approach and ensuring explainability and trustworthiness.

The opportunity is to use AI to build higher-value, more efficient, more scalable, and trustworthy data, information and knowledge services. AI makes the creation of previously unattainable information and knowledge services possible. The benefits are wide-ranging: by utilising AI, hidden patterns, trends, and correlations can be revealed within datasets, thereby enriching the quality and breadth of the services offered. AI enables the deep integration and connection of products and services, offering clients seamless experiences and improved value propositions, while streamlining operations, optimising resource use and advancing sustainability efforts. Clearly, this can only be done with the necessary safeguards, ensuring compliance with the AI Act. Resource needs are substantial, since the necessary information technology system requirements are strict, and there is a need for competent and highly skilled staff. Trustworthiness and explainability are key.

Question | ***Simplification is one of the key political priorities. How did the Office contribute to the burden reduction exercise?***

Hilde Hardeman | The Office has sought to combine its expertise in publishing and providing access to EU law with its know-how in legal analysis and its capacity to use AI-based approaches, in order to analyse and map the EU *acquis* and thereby contribute to simplification and burden reduction. In 2024, the Office devoted particular attention to mapping reporting requirements in the acquis, helping to establish a base line for the ongoing burden reduction exercise, and assisting policy Directorates-General in simplifying and implementing regulation, eliminating redundancies and overlaps while preserving high standards. This work has, in the meantime, become an integral part of the Office's day-to-day operations. It is fully aligned with our thematic objective on a digital European legal space and our crosscutting objectives on harnessing new technologies and reinforcing client orientation. It presents an important avenue that we will further develop in the time ahead.

Executive summary

Main achievements

Management of the Publications Office of the European Union

The year 2024 was one of institutional transition, in which European citizens exercised their democratic right to vote in the European elections. Making trustworthy data and information available in easily accessible multilingual formats was vital. By delivering impactful publishing services to the EU institutions and providing the public with data and information they can trust on how the EU works for them, the Publications Office of the European Union (the Office) helped citizens to take informed decisions and make the most of what the EU has to offer. The challenging geopolitical situation, with disinformation omnipresent, made this work even more important, and put unprecedented pressure on the Office's services for authenticating and publishing EU law to give it legal effect.

Fast technological change brought ever-new challenges. The Office did its utmost to harness new technologies and in particular artificial intelligence (AI) to deliver high-value, efficient and scalable services in a trustworthy, explainable way. Its activities as a centre of excellence for data, information and knowledge management at the service of institutional clients and for citizens businesses and the public at large continued to develop in both scope and impact.

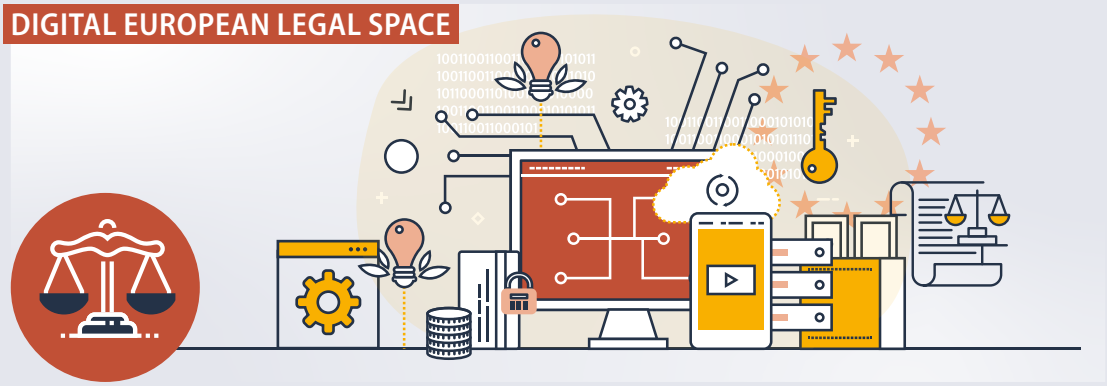
As manager of the body of EU law, the Office made a tangible contribution to reducing the regulatory burden. Through its interinstitutional mandate on standards and formats, the Office played a central role in modernising the systems that underpin the EU's law-making process. Cybersecurity remained a key consideration. Ensuring that the Office is an attractive, motivating and fulfilling workplace, along with bringing in new colleagues, were top priorities.

In addition, 2024 was the year in which the Office updated its strategic objectives. With the unanimous support of its Management Committee, the Office confirmed its current thematic strategic objectives – focusing on data management services in the legal field and for public procurement, European open data, standardisation for interoperability, optimised publishing services, and connecting and preserving content – and complemented these with three cross-cutting objectives: client orientation, strategic outreach and harnessing new technologies in a trustworthy way. This decision sets a clear direction for the Office's operations for the years to come.

Strategic objectives

The steady implementation of the seven strategic objectives, which combine the mission of the Office as a provider of publishing and data management services with a clearly defined role in support of EU policymaking, continued throughout 2024, as highlighted below.

DIGITAL EUROPEAN LEGAL SPACE



The Office made substantial progress in bringing EU and national law closer to people, making it easier to navigate, contextualise and search; eliminating several barriers to smooth navigation in the digital European legal space; and contributing to enhanced transparency on how EU law takes shape.

In 2024, the Office made considerable steps forward in linking national law with EU law. As at the end of 2024, the EUR-Lex website gave access to the texts of national transposition measures of 23 EU Member States (as compared to 18 in 2023). The Office developed a prototype for a new search mechanism on the N-Lex portal that provides access to national law. So far, three Member States deployed the search mechanism, which offers a more sustainable way of accessing national legal databases based on ELI (European legislation identifier) metadata. In 2025, this mechanism will be extended to more countries and equipped with further features. The year 2024 further saw an unprecedented rise in Member States' uptake of the ELI, with 19 Member States having adopted at least the initial stage of ELI development by the end of the year, thanks to the combined outreach efforts of the ELI Task Force and the Office. This represents a tangible shift towards harmonised access to law in the EU.

The Office continued enhancing the usability of the EUR-Lex site and carried out important groundwork when it comes to (i) formats for the exchange and dissemination of legal texts and (ii) methods for large-scale stakeholder consultation. This groundwork will yield benefits for access to legal data and information in the years to come.

The Office further delivered the first version of the EU Law Tracker (EULT), providing transparency on the state of play of files in the EU legislative process, which went live in spring.

PUBLIC PROCUREMENT DATA SPACE



The Office continued its work in developing the public procurement data space. With a view to obtaining and offering access to public procurement data that is structured and standardised, the Office focused on the implementation of **eForms** (standard forms used by public buyers to publish notices in the *Supplement to the Official Journal of the European Union* on the Tenders Electronic Daily (TED) website). As at 1 February 2024, all Member States were using eForms. The use of eForms facilitates interoperability, data analysis and reuse. Interoperability is essential when dealing with information that needs to be published at both the national and European levels, and more generally, facilitates the use and reuse of any type of data.

A **revamped website for TED** was launched and has been successfully in full operation since January 2024. It offers easier, more user-friendly access to public procurement data and to bulk data. It also allows for the extraction of statistical data and provides enhanced search functions and an improved display of results.

The Office finalised the projects launched as part of the European Parliament's **preparatory action on transparency in public procurement** around four axes: data quality, data readability, data interoperability and data availability. This included a contest to reward academic articles related to transparency and the promotion of research projects. The projects and the winners of the contest were presented at the Office's **Public Procurement Data Superpowers** event, held in Brussels in April 2024.

The **public procurement data space (PPDS)** system was officially launched in September. The PPDS system interconnects EU-level and national public procurement databases, opening new possibilities for data analytics to support strategic policy goals within the Single Market, such as greening, innovation or social inclusion. The Office contributes to the PPDS system with the provision of TED data and with the development and maintenance of the eProcurement ontology, the common standard that enables data interoperability.

The Office catered for the **community of users** of its various services related to publishing procurement notices. To facilitate the transition to eForms and to the new TED website, the Office organised a series of online meetings with eSenders, reusers of TED data and users of the web interface for submitting procurement notices, eNotices2. The Office also organised regular meetings with experts supporting its work on the eProcurement ontology and the European Single Procurement Document. The **TED-together event**, held in Luxembourg on 3 and 4 December 2024, brought together these various components of the TED community for the first time. TED events and meetings in 2024 involved about 2 000 participants.

To further improve client satisfaction, the Office continued to enhance supporting materials for users and reusers (e.g. videos, guidance, technical documentation) and launched a usability study on the eNotices2 web interface and on the layout of the procurement forms.

EUROPEAN OPEN DATA SPACE



Through the European open data space, the Office provides services that connect data providers and data reusers. The **official portal for European data**, data.europa.eu is the central point of access to open data, connecting data from various public administrations.
To better understand users and their needs, and thus set up more efficient citizen-centric services, the Office carried out its yearly user survey.

New functionalities and more **detailed documentation** make it easier to use, understand and navigate the data and information provided on the portal and to send, update and, where needed, delete datasets quickly via the portal application programming interface. The new functionalities include data visualisation previews for geospatial and tabular data, the embedding of datasets on other websites with a short code snippet and a more powerful data citation tool with more options to export a citation.

The **metadata quality dashboard** provides real-time feedback on the quality of the metadata of catalogues, datasets and their various formats.

Following the entry into force of Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2023/138 on high-value datasets ([1]), data.europa.eu now features a dedicated section to centralise all EU high-value datasets in a single view. The recommended approach for Member States' reporting obligations is outlined on the platform's documentation page, including queries to enable automatic reporting.
A face-to-face workshop was organised in Paris to offer a discussion forum on open data initiatives in Europe with and between national public administrations. In terms of data literacy, the data.europa academy continued to offer learning material to help make society more data literate. In total, 22 webinars were organised over the year, with an average of 255 participants and 565 registrations per webinar.

([1]) European Commission, Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2023/138 of 21 December 2022 laying down a list of specific high-value datasets and the arrangements for their publication and re-use, OJ L 19, 20.1.2023, p. 43, ELI: http://data.europa.eu/eli/reg_impl/2023/138/oj.

INTERINSTITUTIONAL LEGAL PUBLICATIONS SUPPORT



2024 was the first complete year of the *Official Journal of the European Union* (OJ) being published exclusively act by act, which helped to ensure the delivery of all publications on time in a year that saw a historic record in production volumes. With the act-by-act publication of the OJ, each act is published as soon as it is ready for publication, independently of other acts. This allows for a more flexible, faster and simplified way of publishing. In 2024, the Office published 121 acts on their day of adoption and successfully handled a new record number of pages, publishing over 3 million pages in all official languages, an increase of 52.99 % compared to the previous record year of 2023.

The Office continued its work on the interinstitutional budget information system (IBIS) to support the EU's annual budgetary procedure. Informal testing campaigns with the European Parliament and the European Commission's Directorate-General for Budget (DG Budget), along with a formal production simulation run (PSR) with the European Parliament, allowed the Office to confirm that business requirements were properly assessed and developed, with a view to rolling out the new system in 2026. The Office continued to take all necessary measures to ensure full business continuity with a fully functioning budget production system at all times.

OPTIMISED PUBLISHING SERVICES



In addition to production services for a wide range of output formats, the Office further improved its **service offer of pre- and post-production services**. Support and guidelines for publishing documents in an accessible manner were further enriched and are available in the form of a website, training modules and a drafting tool. As a domain leader in the field of publications, the Office provided printing guidelines and editorial guidelines for authors of EU publications. The Office succeeded in partially automatising the publication performance measurement services to meet the high demand. In 2024, the publishing community of practice received access to the new Publish Smart collaborative site for better knowledge and best practices sharing.

STANDARDISATION SERVICES FOR INTEROPERABILITY



The Commission envisages drafting, as from January 2025, all new legislative proposals pertaining to the ordinary legislative procedure in Akoma Ntoso for EU (AKN4EU). To make this possible, the Office **published in November 2024** on the EU Vocabularies website the **AKN4EU version needed for this purpose**. This work is taking place under the auspices of the Interinstitutional Metadata and Formats Committee (IMFC), chaired and coordinated by the Office. The Office also updated the automated conversion and validation services relating to AKN4EU, which are key assets for the Interinstitutional Interoperability Steering Committee.

When it comes to the standardisation of metadata, a new page documenting the interinstitutional metadata exchange protocol (IMMC) was published on the EU Vocabularies website, reflecting the agreement found by the IMFC on functional names for the two versions of the protocol: IMMC for interinstitutional exchanges and IMMC for document production and archiving.

The Office cemented its role as a reference data management competence centre, offering a comprehensive service package. After the European Commission's Information Management Steering Board (IMSB) confirmed the maturity of this service package as a corporate offering within the Commission in the spring of 2023, the Office continued enhancing its services in 2024.

The successful launch and endorsement by the IMSB in 2023 of the corporate reference data asset for countries and territories, which replaced 75 different lists previously used in the Commission, was followed in 2024 by a green light from the IMSB for the creation of three thematic working groups to develop corporate reference data assets around crops, EU organisational entities and an AI taxonomy. The outcomes are expected in 2025. The Office also continued working on the corporate taxonomies to be used by all Directorates-General (DGs) in SharePoint Online (SPO) and started exploring the use of AI for automatic semantic tagging in this context.

One of the highlights of the year was the launch of the revamped website of the *Interinstitutional Style Guide* (ISG) on 10 June. The new site was presented in six online mini-sessions in June and July for users within the institutions, a session for the Commission's Directorate-General for Translation (DG Translation) and a knowledge hour for the Secretariat-General (SG), attracting around 350 participants altogether. It received extensive positive feedback, with its design and ease of use being particularly appreciated. As for the content, there were two major updates concerning bibliographical references and copyright.

CONNECTING AND PRESERVING KNOWLEDGE AND CONTENT



The Office further reinforced its standing as a key player providing data, research and information management services in support of evidence-based policymaking, with a central role being played by the Office's **European Commission Library** (EC Library) team. The EC Library team proposed corporate acquisition guidelines that were endorsed by the IMSB and successfully implemented. Other important achievements in 2024 were the conclusion of an interinstitutional framework contract for the supply of books, yearbooks, updates and monographic series and the launch of a project to implement a union catalogue in collaboration with six other EU institutions and bodies. The EC Library team continued to support the evidence-based policymaking process by delivering tailored library research products and by enhancing the EC Data Catalogue to facilitate the discovery of key data assets in the Commission and its executive agencies.

Following its formal endorsement in 2023, the Evidence Transparency Service became fully operational in 2024. The overarching goal of this service is to help policy officers identify, access, retrieve and (re)use evidence cited in impact assessments and evaluations. It covers various aspects of the impact assessment /evaluation journey, from finding and identifying evidence to the process of publication and beyond. Several presentations were given to DGs and a new SPO site was launched.

Also in 2024, the Office took the lead in the **Data Advisory Service**, a key service providing access to support and information on all things data-related at the Commission.

Service offer of the Publications Office of the European Union

Centred around these seven strategic objectives, the Office provides a range of services for the production, access to, reuse and long-term preservation of public information and data. With the help of data visualisation, the graph below sets out in an easily understandable way the full range of services which the Office provides to the EU institutions and to the public.



(*) Legislative acts adopted under the ordinary legislative procedure and non-legislative acts of institutions must be published in the Official Journal to enter into force.

(**) Decision of the European Parliament, the Council, the Commission, the Court of Justice, the Court of Auditors, the European Economic and Social Committee and the Committee of the Regions of 26 June 2009 on the organisation and operation of the Publications Office of the European Union.

(***) Decision on the reuse of Commission documents, including the creation of a data portal as single point of access, overseen by a steering committee chaired by the Publications Office.

2024 highlights

CONNECTING AND PRESERVING KNOWLEDGE AND CONTENT

1. Successful implementation of the corporate guidelines for data acquisition.
2. Ingestion of the new collection of published TED notices into the digital archive.
3. Formal launch of the union catalogue project.
4. Launch of the **DORIE** (Documentation and Research on European Institutional Issues) service on the OP Portal.
5. Launch of the 'Public procurement procedure view' on the OP Portal.

STANDARDISATION SERVICES FOR INTEROPERABILITY

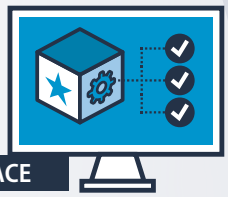
1. New ISG website came online in June 2024, completing the modernisation process of the ISG infrastructure.
2. **AKN4EU** release published, to be used in production from January 2025 by the EU institutions.
3. IMSB endorsed the creation of three thematic working groups to develop corporate reference data assets on crops, EU organisational entities and an AI taxonomy.

OPTIMISED PUBLISHING SERVICES

1. In the context of the Clear Writing Awards organised by the Commission's DG Translation, the Office won two awards:
   - a Clear Writing Award for *Publish to Be Read – Editorial guidelines for authors of EU publications*,
   - a Special Achievement Award for promoting inclusive and accessible language.
2. 563 reports issued by the Office's **publication performance measurement services**, more than three times as many as in 2022.

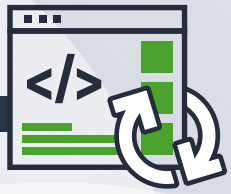
INTERINSTITUTIONAL LEGAL PUBLICATIONS SUPPORT

1. **Record number of Official Journal pages** published: more than 3 million.
2. 121 acts published on their day of adoption: 2 770 pages.



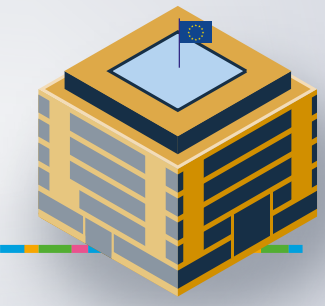
DIGITAL EUROPEAN LEGAL SPACE

1. **EU Law Tracker:** first version of the portal is online.
2. Linking of EU and national law: transposition measures of 23 Member States accessible via EUR-Lex; pilot version of ELI-based searches in national legal databases available on N-Lex; 19 Member States adopted the ELI.



PUBLIC PROCUREMENT DATA SPACE

1. New TED website launched.
2. **eForms** for procurement notices: **full implementation**.
3. Budget savings through automation and machine translation of notices.





CORDIS AND RESEARCH RESULTS SERVICES

1. Celebration of the 30th anniversary of the **Community Research and Development Information Service** (CORDIS) website
2. Use of the European Science Vocabulary (EuroSciVoc) for classification of projects on the Kohesio website
3. Machine translation introduced to cover all EU languages.



EUROPEAN OPEN DATA SPACE

1. **Section for high-value datasets** available on data.europa.eu.
2. 18 data stories published.
3. 22 webinars offered.

Key facts and figures for **2024**

Documentary units available on **EUR-Lex**:

1 126 738.

3 072 181

pages of the Official Journal

published in 24 languages – a historic record (i.e. an increase of 52.99 % compared to the previous record year of 2023).

Number of **visits** to the Office's websites:

86 296 557

EUR-Lex: **60 633 623.**
TED: **6 333 461.**
OP Portal: **10 506 795.**
CORDIS: **6 895 325.**
data.europa.eu: **1 927 353.**

1 472 participants

in **e-learning** courses and training modules on publishing activities for EU institutions, with a **99 % satisfaction rate**.

1 658 subscribers to the Publish Smart newsletter.

25 training sessions and 15 custom-made webinars on **accessibility** delivered for

1 100+ EU staff.

61.4 % of the publications produced by the Office accessible to people with disabilities.

Production and dissemination of bibliographic records:

21 352

new publication notices.

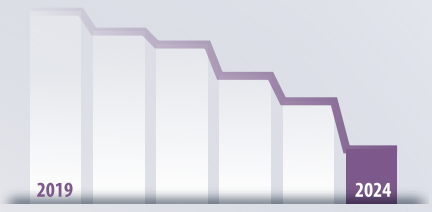
Assignment of identifiers:

31 882

digital object identifiers (DOIs) registered.

The ***Interinstitutional Style Guide*** **(ISG)** consulted by **767 008 visitors**; **1 288 345** ISG pages visited.

Destocking of print runs



Stock available as at 31 December 2024:
2.83 million (decreasing trend).

Number of standard pages corrected:

2 557 244

(+ 4 %; 2 458 821 in 2023).



Budget

Budget committed:
EUR **128.21 million**
(delegated lines, all fund sources).



Vacancy rate as at 31 December 2024:
1.9 %
(< average Commission rate).

Posts



Use of the EC Library e-collections

- **5 785 350 articles** accessed.
- **64 398 ebooks** consulted.

data.europa.eu datasets

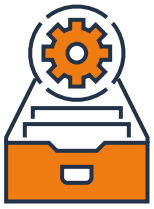
19 465 datasets
from EU institutions.



1 784 068 datasets
from national European data and geospatial catalogues.



10 370 subscribers to the **OP Newsletter** via e-mail and **10 634** subscribers via LinkedIn.



- Number of new documents added to the physical archives: **253 975** (302 general publications, the rest being acts of the Official Journal).
- Number of documents ingested in the long-term digital repository: **51 202**.
- Number of new seeds added for the web archive collections: **210** (81 of which are now part of regular quarterly crawls).
- Number of HTML publications added to the web archives: **383** (1 770 language versions).



Number of pages of consolidated texts produced and published on EUR-Lex:
3 788 7340.

A record of **801 444** EU public procurement notices published on TED.



TED published an average of **3 137** EU public procurement notices per publication day.



Number of summaries, glossary terms and introductory texts produced/updated and published on EUR-Lex:
234.

GETTING IN TOUCH WITH THE EU

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FINDING INFORMATION ABOUT THE EU

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Information about the European Union in all the official languages of the EU is available on the Europa website (europa.eu).

EU publications

You can view or order EU publications at op.europa.eu/en/publications. Multiple copies of free publications can be obtained by contacting Europe Direct or your local documentation centre (european-union.europa.eu/contact-eu/meet-us_en).

EU law and related documents

For access to legal information from the EU, including all EU law since 1951 in all the official language versions, go to EUR-Lex (eur-lex.europa.eu).

Open data from the EU

The portal data.europa.eu provides access to open datasets from the EU institutions, bodies and agencies. These can be downloaded and reused for free, for both commercial and non-commercial purposes. The portal also provides access to a wealth of datasets from European countries



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of the European Union